MONARCH DETAILING

PREMIUM MOBILE CAR CARE — GOLD COAST & BRISBANE

Standard Operating Procedure

Paint Correction

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1 Equipment Needed

ITEM	NOTES
DA polisher (dual action)	*Primary correction tool*
Menzerna cutting compound	*Heavy cut — defect removal*
Menzerna finishing polish	*Fine finish — refine to high gloss*
Foam cutting pad	*Orange or yellow*
Foam finishing pad	*Black or blue*
Clay bar + clay lubricant	*Decontamination stage*
IPA (isopropyl alcohol) panel wipe	*Reveals true finish, removes polish oils*
Microfibre towels	*Minimum 10 per job*
Masking tape	*For trim, badges, rubber — non-negotiable*
LED inspection light	*Swirl finder — essential for QC*
Paint depth gauge	*Recommended — protects against over-correction*

2 Stages of Correction

1-STAGE	2-STAGE	3-STAGE

Enhancement	Correction	Show Prep
60–70%	**80–90%**	**95%+**
DEFECT REMOVAL	DEFECT REMOVAL	DEFECT REMOVAL
Single cutting step + finish	Heavy cut + finishing pass	Wet sand + heavy cut + finishing
4–5 hours	**6–8 hours**	**Quote only**

3 Process — 2-Stage Correction

PREP

1 WASH

Full decontamination wash. Foam, hand wash, rinse. Vehicle must be spotless before any machine touches it.

2 CLAY BAR

Clay entire vehicle with lubricant. Removes bonded contaminants the wash missed. Run your hand over the paint — it should feel like glass.

3 DRY

Full hand dry. Blow out crevices with compressed air or leaf blower. No water spots allowed.

4 MASK

Tape all trim, badges, rubber seals, plastic surrounds. Protects from compound burn. **Non-negotiable.**

5 INSPECT

Use LED light at multiple angles. Identify defects. Mark worst panels. This is your baseline.

CORRECTION

6 CUTTING PASS

DA polisher + cutting pad + Menzerna heavy cut compound. Work **60cm × 60cm sections**. Medium pressure, slow arm speed, 3–4 passes per section. Wipe residue with microfibre.

7 **INSPECT**

LED light check. Did the defects come out? If not, repeat section. Don't move on until you're satisfied.

8 **FINISHING PASS**

DA polisher + finishing pad + Menzerna finishing polish. Same sections. Light pressure, medium speed. Refines the finish to high gloss.

9 **IPA WIPE**

Panel wipe all corrected surfaces. Removes polish oils. Reveals true finish — what you see now is the real result.

10 **FINAL INSPECT**

LED light at all angles. Confirm 80–90% defect removal. Document any remaining deep scratches (may need wet sanding on next visit).

PROTECTION

11 **SEALANT**

Apply spray sealant or ceramic sealant to lock in the correction. All that work means nothing without protection.

12 **FINAL BUFF**

Light buff with clean microfibre. Remove any sealant residue. Stand back and admire.

1-STAGE SHORTCUT

For 1-stage enhancement: skip steps 6–7 (cutting pass). Go straight to finishing polish with a light cutting pad. Same prep, same protection — less correction.

4 Quality Checklist

- [ ] All panels corrected evenly
- [ ] No holograms (buffer trails) visible
- [ ] No compound residue in panel gaps
- [ ] Trim tape removed cleanly
- [ ] Sealant applied and buffed
- [ ] Before/after photos taken (macro shots showing swirl removal)
- [ ] Paint depth measured before and after (didn't remove too much clear coat)

5 Critical Rules

PAINT DEPTH: ALWAYS check paint depth before cutting. Thin clear coat = less correction possible. Measure, don't guess.

SHADE ONLY: Work in the shade, never in direct sunlight. Compound dries too fast and becomes impossible to remove.

LUBRICATION: Keep pad and surface lubricated at all times. Dry buffing burns paint — no exceptions.

PAD MAINTENANCE: Replace pads when clogged. A saturated pad generates heat, not correction.

MASK EVERYTHING: Tape all plastic and rubber surfaces. Compound stains trim permanently — and it looks amateur.

This document is confidential and intended for Monarch Detailing team members only.